02 / CYBERSECURITY CASE STUDY - DEFENSIVE RESPONSE

Responding to suspicious inquiries.

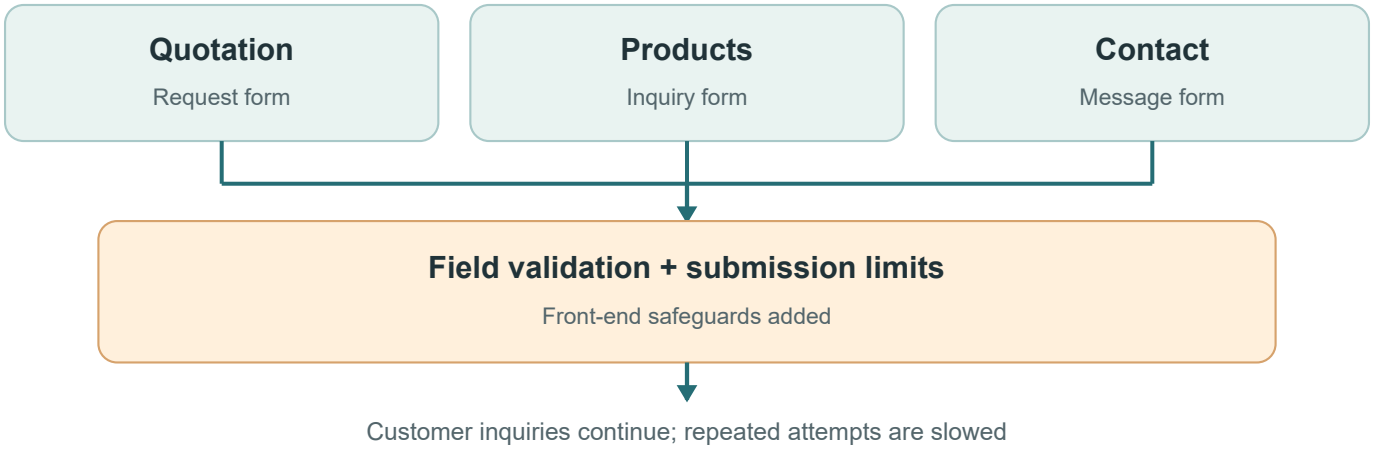
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After the website went live, I received an inquiry that appeared to be automated. It prompted me to strengthen the front-end checks on the quotation, product, and contact forms with better field validation and submission limits.

OBSERVED	RESPONSE
A suspicious inquiry reached the site. The message raised a concern about possible form spam; it was not proof of a confirmed intrusion.	**Protected three public forms.** I improved field validation and limited repeated submissions across the quotation, product, and contact forms.

PUBLIC FORMS / ILLUSTRATIVE PROTECTION FLOW



Illustrative form-protection flow, not a screenshot of the suspicious inquiry or a measurement of blocked traffic.

01 / What was the security concern?

A public inquiry form can attract repeated or unwanted submissions. The suspicious message suggested possible automated form abuse, so I treated it as a warning sign and reviewed all three customer-facing forms.

Risks, response, and continued protection

02 / How could a bot submit inquiries?

Scripts can send requests to a public form repeatedly, often faster than a person would. Browser-side checks improve the experience but can be bypassed if the server does not enforce its own rules.

03 / Why does it matter?

Spam can bury genuine customer requests, fill inquiry records, and generate unnecessary notification emails. A busy inbox can delay a response to a real quotation or product question.

04 / What did I change?

I strengthened field validation and added submission rate limits to the quotation, product, and contact forms. These front-end improvements help reject invalid entries and slow repeated attempts while keeping the forms usable for customers.

05 / How should the protection be maintained?

Form rules and rate limits should be enforced where submissions are processed, then checked against real traffic so legitimate customers are not blocked. Suspicious patterns can be monitored without publishing customer messages or personal details.

> **SCOPE OF THE RESPONSE**
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> This case describes suspicious form activity and front-end improvements. A confirmed intrusion, server-side rate limiting, and measured reductions in spam are not established by the evidence presented here.

Further reading

OWASP Bot Management and Anti-Automation Cheat Sheet

Linked guidance from the portfolio case study. Source: cheatsheetseries.owasp.org